

PAID TO GOVERN. PAID TO SURVIVE.

What Alberta pays the people who govern, set beside what it provides the disabled Albertans it governs.

All figures sourced. Most recent published, 2025-2026.

THE SAME MONTH. THE SAME LAW.

JUNE 1, 2026: +\$500 / month each for 8 MLAs (a new \$6,000 / year allowance for parliamentary secretaries).

JULY 1, 2026: -\$200 / month for ~79,000 disabled Albertans moved to ADAP, with no right to appeal the move.

Both were created by the same statute: Bill 12, the Financial Statutes Amendment Act.

WHAT THE PROVINCE PAYS TO GOVERN (gross, per year / per month)

	ANNUAL	MONTHLY
Calgary mayor	\$220,298	\$18,358
Premier of Alberta	\$196,558	\$16,380
Cabinet minister who runs ADAP	\$191,515	\$15,960
MLA base salary (as of April 1, 2026)	\$127,677	\$10,640
Calgary city councillor	\$124,462	\$10,372
+ NEW parliamentary-secretary allowance (8 MLAs)	+\$6,000	+\$500
+ MLA second-home allowance, tax-free (60+ km out)	up to \$26,400	up to \$2,200

The parliamentary-secretary allowance also comes with reimbursed travel, meal, and hospitality expenses, on top of the \$6,000.

WHAT THE PROVINCE PROVIDES TO SURVIVE (per year / per month)

	ANNUAL	MONTHLY
Full-time minimum-wage worker (\$15/hr, gross)	\$31,200	\$2,600
AISH (headline \$1,940/mo)	\$23,280	\$1,940
ADAP (headline \$1,740/mo)	\$20,880	\$1,740

AFTER the \$200 Canada Disability Benefit clawback (taken regardless, see reverse):

AISH real: \$20,880 / yr | \$1,740 / mo ADAP real: \$18,480 / yr | \$1,540 / mo

THE GAP, IN YEARS AND IN RENT

THE \$200 THAT DISAPPEARS EITHER WAY

The federal Canada Disability Benefit pays up to \$200/month. Alberta is the only province or territory that takes it back, and a recipient loses the \$200 no matter what:

- If the federal benefit has not been decided yet, Alberta cuts \$200 from the provincial benefit anyway (began April 2026).
- If the federal benefit IS received, Alberta claws it back dollar-for-dollar.

Net benefit to the recipient: zero. Either way, the real monthly amount is \$200 below the headline.

HOW MANY YEARS TO EARN WHAT THEY MAKE IN ONE (using the real, post-clawback benefit)

One year of their pay equals...	FOR AN AISH RECIPIENT	FOR AN ADAP RECIPIENT
Calgary mayor (\$220,298)	10.6 years	11.9 years
Premier (\$196,558)	9.4 years	10.6 years
Cabinet minister who runs ADAP (\$191,515)	9.2 years	10.4 years
MLA (\$127,677)	6.1 years	6.9 years

AND THEN RENT

The average Alberta one-bedroom rents for about \$1,450/month (Calgary \$1,531, Edmonton \$1,302). Paid out of the real benefit, here is what is left for food, power, phone, transit, and medication for the entire month:

AISH (\$1,740 real) minus average rent (\$1,450)	\$290 left / month
ADAP (\$1,540 real) minus average rent (\$1,450)	\$90 left / month
ADAP (\$1,540 real) minus Calgary rent (\$1,531)	\$9 left / month

Meanwhile, the MLA second-home allowance, roughly \$2,200/month and tax-free, is larger than a disabled Albertan's entire monthly income on either program. The province pays more to keep an MLA's spare apartment than it provides a disabled person to live on.

AND THE GAP IS BUILT TO WIDEN

Political pay is indexed and rose again on April 1, 2026 (MLAs +3.1%). Bill 12, the same law behind the transition, removed the legislated requirement for annual cost-of-living increases to disability benefits. Their pay climbs every year. The disability benefit does not.

Notes: Salary figures are gross; AISH and ADAP are non-taxable, so their amounts are take-home. Political pay is taxed, which narrows take-home somewhat but still leaves four to nine times a disabled person's income. The second-home allowance is the published flat rate and has likely been adjusted upward since. This is a comparison of public spending priorities, not a claim that any one payment funds another.

Sources: MLA base, Premier, and cabinet-minister salaries (all effective April 1, 2026) - Legislative Assembly of Alberta. The \$6,000 parliamentary-secretary allowance (OIC 2026/147, eff. June 1, 2026) - Edmonton Journal, May 8, 2026. Calgary mayor and councillor - CBC / Global News, Jan 2025. Minimum wage - Government of Alberta (frozen since 2018). Rent - rentals.ca / CMHC, early 2026. MLA accommodation allowance (\$2,200/month) - Members' Allowances Order; CBC / Global News. CDB clawback - Government of Alberta AISH deposit statements; Inclusion Alberta. AISH/ADAP rates and Bill 12 - Government of Alberta.

AND THEY ARE NOT EVEN AT WORK

The cut lands July 1. The members who passed it have already gone home for the summer.

THE 54-DAY YEAR

Alberta's Legislature is scheduled to sit just 54 days in all of 2026. The spring sitting ended in mid-May. The House is not scheduled to sit again until after the October 19 referendum, roughly five months later. The benefit cut takes effect July 1, in the middle of that recess, while the Assembly that passed it is not sitting.

None of this stops during those five months:

- The full MLA salary (\$127,677 base) keeps being paid.
- The accommodation allowance, up to \$2,200/month and tax-free, keeps covering eligible MLAs' second homes in Edmonton.
- Every constituency office keeps running on a taxpayer-funded budget for rent, utilities, paper, printing, postage and supplies, plus staff. MLAs voted themselves an extra \$6,000 each for leasing and staff in 2025.
- Publicly funded constituency-office staff keep drawing salaries to answer the phones and the email.
- Travel is reimbursed, under the Members' Allowances, Constituency Services, and Transportation Orders.

Across all 87 seats, the Assembly's MLA-administration budget (salaries, offices, staff and allowances) runs \$39.9 million for 2025-26, with a further \$10.7 million for caucus offices.

If you stopped showing up to your job for five months, you would be fired. No one would keep paying your salary. No one would cover your rent, your office, your printing, or your staff. No one would reimburse your commute. You would have to survive until you were back at work. The roughly 79,000 disabled Albertans facing this cut have to. The members who voted for it do not. And you pay for theirs.

AND THEY CALL IT FISCALLY RESPONSIBLE

The Premier defends cutting disabled Albertans and moving them onto a work-focused program as fiscally responsible. The government's own Budget 2026 shows the opposite.

Cost to administer AISH (2025-26)	\$46.8 million
Cost to administer ADAP (2026-27)	\$88.4 million
Increase, every single year	+\$41.6 million (+89%)

That is \$41.6 million more, every year, to run a program that pays disabled people less. Inclusion Alberta puts the new administrative build at \$45.7 million, a 107% increase. Either way: costlier administration, smaller benefit. A program that costs more to deliver less is not a saving. It is a choice.

Sources: 54 sitting days and the spring/fall schedule - CBC News (Feb 24, 2026); Global News (May 2026); Legislative Assembly of Alberta 2026 Sessional Calendar. MLA salary, accommodation allowance (raised 14% to \$2,200/month, Nov 2024), constituency-office staffing and operating budgets, and travel - Members' Allowances Order, Constituency Services Order, and Transportation Order (Legislative Assembly of Alberta); CBC / Global News, Jan 2025. Constituency-office and caucus budgets, the MLA-administration envelope, and the \$6,000 office top-up - Legislative Assembly Members' Services Committee (Feb 11, 2025). ADAP vs AISH administration cost - Alberta Budget 2026; Inclusion Alberta, 2026.

AND WHAT THEY SPENT ON THEMSELVES

From the government's own public expense disclosure, the same years it built the cut.

THE GOVERNMENT'S OWN EXPENSE RECORD (Oct 11, 2022 - May 29, 2025)

While it legislated a \$200-a-month cut for roughly 79,000 disabled Albertans, the Government of Alberta's own published travel and expense disclosure records the following for the same window:

Total disclosed travel and expenses	82,260 claims	\$9,717,635
Travel		\$8,759,534
Out-of-country airfare alone		\$1,131,348
Hospitality	609 items	\$178,278
Top ministry: Executive Council	10,916 items	\$1,813,423
Premier Danielle Smith, personally	439 claims	\$124,899
Largest single claim (lodging, COP29 climate mission)		\$19,512

The Premier's own disclosed travel and expenses over that window, \$124,899, is more than six years of a disabled Albertan's entire income on ADAP after the clawback (\$18,480 a year).

AND THIS IS THE PARTIAL FIGURE

These numbers come from the last complete archived copy of the government's own dataset, which ends May 29, 2025, so the true total is higher. In August 2025 the government quietly removed eight years of expense receipts from its website, then restored them after cross-party backlash.

Travel and hospitality are part of governing, and the point is not any single trip. The point is priorities: in the same years it built a permanent cut for the province's most disabled citizens, this is what the government spent moving itself around the world. Every figure here is the government's own public disclosure.

Source: Government of Alberta - Travel and Expense Disclosure (Treasury Board and Finance), archived dataset covering Oct 11, 2022 - May 29, 2025.
August 2025 receipt removal and reversal: CBC News, August 2025.